

CourtrightCollective

MORE REVIEWS, HONESTLY

COURTRIGHT COLLECTIVE

The Google Review Booster *Kit*

How to get more reviews without begging, without breaking Google's rules, and without a monthly subscription to a review app.

GUIDE + TEMPLATES

COMPLIANT

30 MIN SETUP

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BUILT IN NASHVILLE

The Google Review Booster Kit

Why this matters more than almost anything else you could do this month

Reviews are the cheapest marketing you will ever have access to, and most small businesses are leaving them on the table for one reason: **nobody asks**.

Here's the thing. Your happy customers are genuinely willing to leave you a review. They are not withholding it. They just walked out the door thinking about lunch, and the thought never occurred to them. The gap between "would happily review you" and "actually reviewed you" is almost entirely a gap of asking, at the right moment, with a link that takes one tap.

Three things move the needle, in this order:

- 1. How recently you got reviews.** A business with 40 reviews from this year outperforms one with 200 reviews from 2019. Recency signals that you are still open and still good.
- 2. How many you have.** More is better, but the returns flatten. Going from 5 to 30 changes your business. Going from 200 to 230 does not.
- 3. Whether you reply.** Replying is visible to every future customer and it is the single most overlooked lever in this entire document.

This kit is the whole system: the link, the ask, the templates, the replies, and the rhythm.

Part 1: Set up the link (15 minutes, do it once)

If your ask takes more than one tap, your review rate collapses. So the first job is a link that opens straight to the five-star box.

▪ Get your short review link

1. Sign in to your Google Business Profile (search your business name while signed in, or go to business.google.com)
2. Find **Ask for reviews** or **Get more reviews**
3. Copy the link. It will look like `g.page/r/XXXXXXXXX/review`
4. Test it on your own phone. It should open the review box directly, with no extra taps

▪ The manual method, if that button is missing

Google moves this feature around. If you cannot find it:

1. Find your Place ID using Google's Place ID Finder (search "Google Place ID Finder")
2. Build the URL: `https://search.google.com/local/writereview?placeid=YOUR\_PLACE\_ID`
3. Test it on a phone

- **Shorten it and make it memorable**

A link somebody can type beats a link they have to copy. Set up a redirect on your own domain:

- [yoursite.com/review](#) → your Google review link

On most website platforms this is a one-line redirect rule. It is worth the ten minutes because it works in a phone call, on a receipt, and read out loud.

- **Make the QR code**

Use the free QR Menu Maker at [courtrightco.com](#), or any QR generator, and point it at your review link. Print it on:

- Table tents, if people sit down
- The counter, right at the register
- Receipts and invoices
- The back of your business card
- The bag or the box, if you hand people things
- A small card handed over at the end of the job

Printing rules: minimum one inch square, keep the white border, never on a curved surface. Test it from where the customer actually stands.

Part 2: The rules you must not break

Google removes reviews and, in bad cases, restricts profiles. These rules are not suggestions.

Never offer anything in exchange for a review. No discounts, no free items, no entry into a drawing, no loyalty points. Not even for "an honest review." This is the rule people break most often and it is the one with the sharpest teeth.

Never review-gate. Review gating means asking how somebody feels first and only sending the review link to the ones who say something nice. It is explicitly against Google's policy. Ask everybody, the same way. Yes, that means occasionally getting a review you did not want. That is the deal, and it is a better deal than it sounds, because a page of nothing but five stars reads as fake to modern customers anyway.

Never write reviews for your own business. Not you, not your staff, not your cousin who genuinely did eat there.

Never buy reviews. Detection is good and getting better, and the penalty is not worth it.

Do not set up a kiosk or tablet where everyone reviews you from the same device and IP. A cluster of reviews from one connection looks exactly like what fake reviews look like, and it gets filtered.

What you absolutely can do: ask every customer, every time, in person, by email, by text, on a receipt, on a card, on a sign, with a QR code, and follow up once. All of that is fine and all of it works.

Part 3: The ask

▪ Timing beats wording

The best moment to ask is **immediately after the customer says something good**. Not later that week. Right then, while they are feeling it.

Watch for these moments:

- "This turned out great"
- "Thank you so much"
- "You saved me"
- A repeat visit
- A referral they sent you
- The job finishing on time and on budget
- Any moment somebody smiles at you

That is your cue. Every time.

▪ The in-person ask, word for word

"Hey, I'm really glad that worked out. Would you mind leaving us a Google review? It genuinely helps people find us. I can text you the link right now if that is easier."

Then **actually send the text while they are standing there**. The ask converts at a completely different rate when the link arrives before they leave.

▪ The three rules of asking

- 1. Ask in person if you can.** A face-to-face ask converts several times better than an email. It is a little uncomfortable the first ten times and then it is not.
- 2. Send the link immediately.** Not later. Now, while you are together.
- 3. Ask once, follow up once, then stop.** A third ask makes you the business that nags.

▪ Training your team

If someone else talks to customers, they need three things:

- The exact sentence to say, printed and posted somewhere
- The link saved in their phone as a text shortcut
- Permission to ask, said out loud by you, more than once

Track asks, not just reviews. If nobody is asking, no template on earth will save you.

Part 4: Handling the reviews you get

▪ Reply to every single one

Every review, five star and one star. Within 48 hours if you can.

Replies are public and permanent. Every future customer reading your page sees them. A thoughtful reply to a bad review does more for you than three good reviews do, because it shows the thing people actually want to know: **what happens when something goes wrong**.

▪ The one-star that is fair

Take responsibility, fix it, move the conversation off the page. Do not argue, do not list what the customer got wrong, do not explain your policy in four paragraphs.

The structure that works: thank them, acknowledge the specific problem, say what you are doing about it, give a direct way to reach you. Four sentences.

▪ The one-star that is not fair

You will get one. Somebody had a bad day, or confused you with another business, or wanted something you never offered.

Reply anyway, calmly, factually, once. Your reply is not for that person. It is for the next hundred people who read it, and calm always wins that audience.

If it violates Google's policy (spam, off-topic, a competitor, conflict of interest, or a review of a business that is not yours) you can report it through your profile. Report it once, then let it go. Success rates are honestly mediocre, and a calm public reply protects you either way.

▪ The five-star

Reply to these too. Most businesses do not, which is exactly why it stands out. Two sentences, specific to what they said, and mention something that helps a future reader.

Part 5: The rhythm

WHEN	DO THIS
Every transaction	Ask, in person, at the good moment
Same day	Send the link by text or email
3 days later	One follow-up. Then stop
Twice a week	Reply to every new review
Monthly	Log your review count and average rating
Monthly	Check that your ask actually happened. Count asks, not just reviews
Quarterly	Refresh your printed cards and signs. They get grubby and ignored

A realistic target: if you ask every customer and make the link one tap, expect somewhere around 5 to 15 percent to actually leave one. So thirty asks a month is a few reviews a month, which is roughly forty a year, which will put you ahead of nearly every competitor on your street.

Slow and steady also looks natural. Twenty reviews in one afternoon looks purchased, and Google's filters agree.

Part 6: Track it

Use `Review-Tracker.csv` in this kit. Two tabs' worth of columns, one job each:

- **Asks:** who you asked, when, how, and whether it converted. This is the number you actually control.
- **Reviews:** what came in, the rating, whether you replied, and what it was about.

Filling in the second one takes five minutes a month. The first one is where the improvement comes from, because it turns "we should ask more" into a number you can look at.

The whole thing in seven lines

1. Get the one-tap link. Shorten it to `yoursite.com/review`.
2. Put a QR code everywhere a customer's hands already are.
3. Ask in person, right after they say something good.
4. Send the link while they are still standing there.
5. Follow up once. Never twice.
6. Reply to every review, good and bad, within 48 hours.
7. Never offer anything in exchange, and never ask only the happy ones.

That is the entire system. Everything else in this kit is just the wording.

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